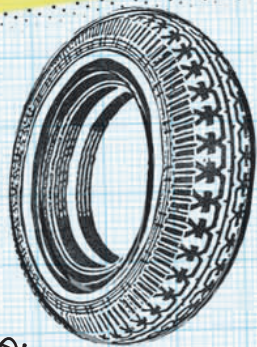


Everyday inventions

INVENTING stuff we can't live without

Every so often, someone comes along and invents something that makes us wonder how we ever did without it. Here are the people behind some of those "must have" inventions.



Vulcanized rubber is tough, flexible, and durable, making it perfect for tires

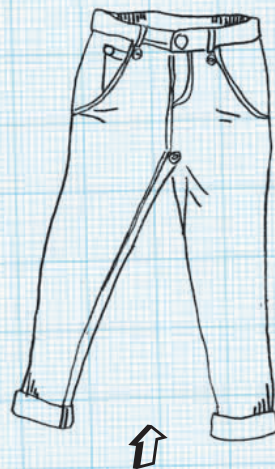


Charles Goodyear (1800–1860)

If your car's tires were made of natural rubber, they would **melt in the summer and freeze in the winter**... pretty useless. Fortunately, this American inventor worked out how to **VULCANIZE** (harden) rubber by **heating** it and mixing it with chemicals.

Levi Strauss (1829–1902)

Can you imagine Elvis wearing corduroy? An American tailor named Jacob Davis started **putting metal rivets on work trousers** to give them **extra strength**. His business partner, a German named Levi Strauss, patented, produced, and promoted the new "**JEANS**."



Jeans became a rock and roll fashion icon